

Education Session #7

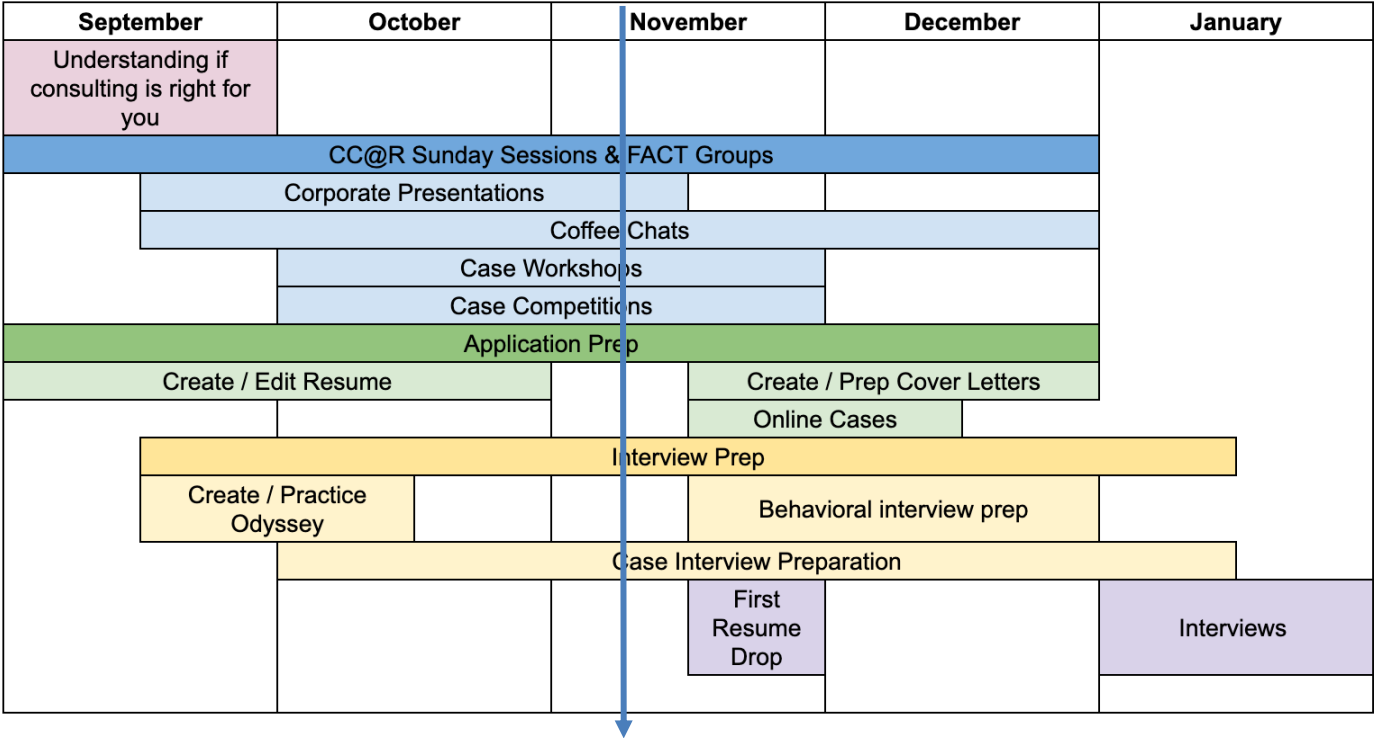
When you connect the
first two pieces in a
5000 piece puzzle set



Bringing It All Together, Piece by Piece

November 5, 2022

Big Picture: Recruiting Timeline



You are here!

Application Deadlines



Company Name	Application Deadline	Cover Letter Requirements
Mckinsey	Monday, November 13, 2023	
Bain	Sunday, November 19, 2023	
LEK	Monday, November 20, 2023	Mandatory
Pw/Strategy&	Tuesday, November 21, 2023	
BCG	Sunday, November 26, 2023	
EY Consulting	Sunday, November 26, 2023	
Alix Partners	Friday, December 1, 2023	
Fidelity Consulting	Friday, December 1, 2023	Mandatory
Accenture	Friday, December 1, 2023	
Alvarez & Marsal	Saturday, December 2, 2023	
EYP	Sunday, December 3, 2023	
Chartis Group	Monday, December 4, 2023	
Deloitte	Wednesday, December 6, 2023	Mandatory
Kearney	Wednesday, December 6, 2023	
Roland Berger	Monday, December 11, 2023	

- Bringing the whole case together
- Getting better at casing
 - Resources
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Remember the goal of all of this...

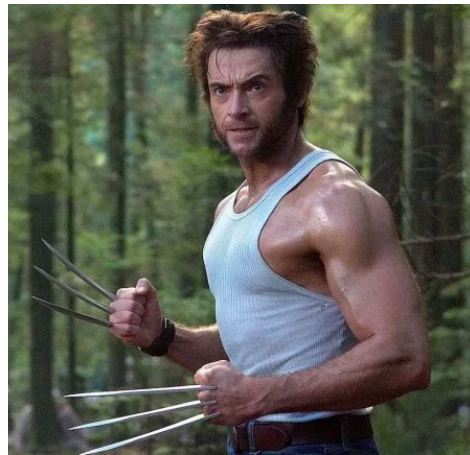


*best chance of offer

... and what casing is all about

Hypothesis Driven: You can understand new situations and form a hypothesis to guide your analysis.

Analytical: There is analytical rigor to your conclusions and recommendations. Are you comfortable with numbers?



YOU, AN
INCREDIBLE
CONSULTANT

Structured: you can bring structure to complex problems; break them down to independent, manageable components

Engaged: Are you engaging and enjoyable to work with? You still need to be professional.

Bringing it all together: Planning

Case Interview (~30 Minutes)

Planning

Analysis

Recommendation

Prompt

- Focus on what the interviewer is saying & write down important elements
- Think through any personal references, new articles, or work experience you have that might be relevant and interesting to the case

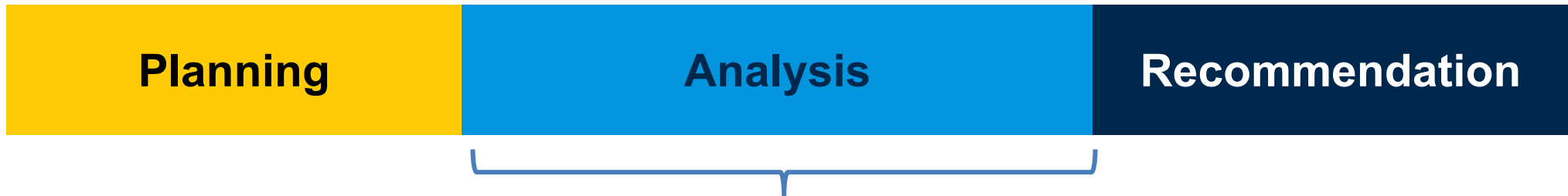
Clarifying Questions

- Take a breath, and think about what questions you would need to answer to better understand the situation or goal
- *Do not ask questions just to ask questions*

Framework

- Aim for ~2 mins, longer is OK for a great framework
- Make it as MECE as possible
- Try to think of one creative / innovative / personal idea for every framework
- Move the case forward by having an area you want to start looking into

Case Interview (~30 Minutes)



Brainstorming questions

- Be structured, even if the interviewer says to not be structured

Quant

- Eyes on the prize: How is the info you're given relevant to the goal?
- Organize the math on your paper and explain what you're doing
- Calculate and drive the case forward --> what's next?

Charts

- Take a moment to orient yourself, make sure you look at each axis and all footnotes – clarify anything that is unclear
- Dive into key findings but *always keep your goal in mind*
- Be curious and interested in second layer insights and move the case forward

Bringing it all together: Recommendation

Case Interview (~30 Minutes)

Planning

Analysis

Recommendation

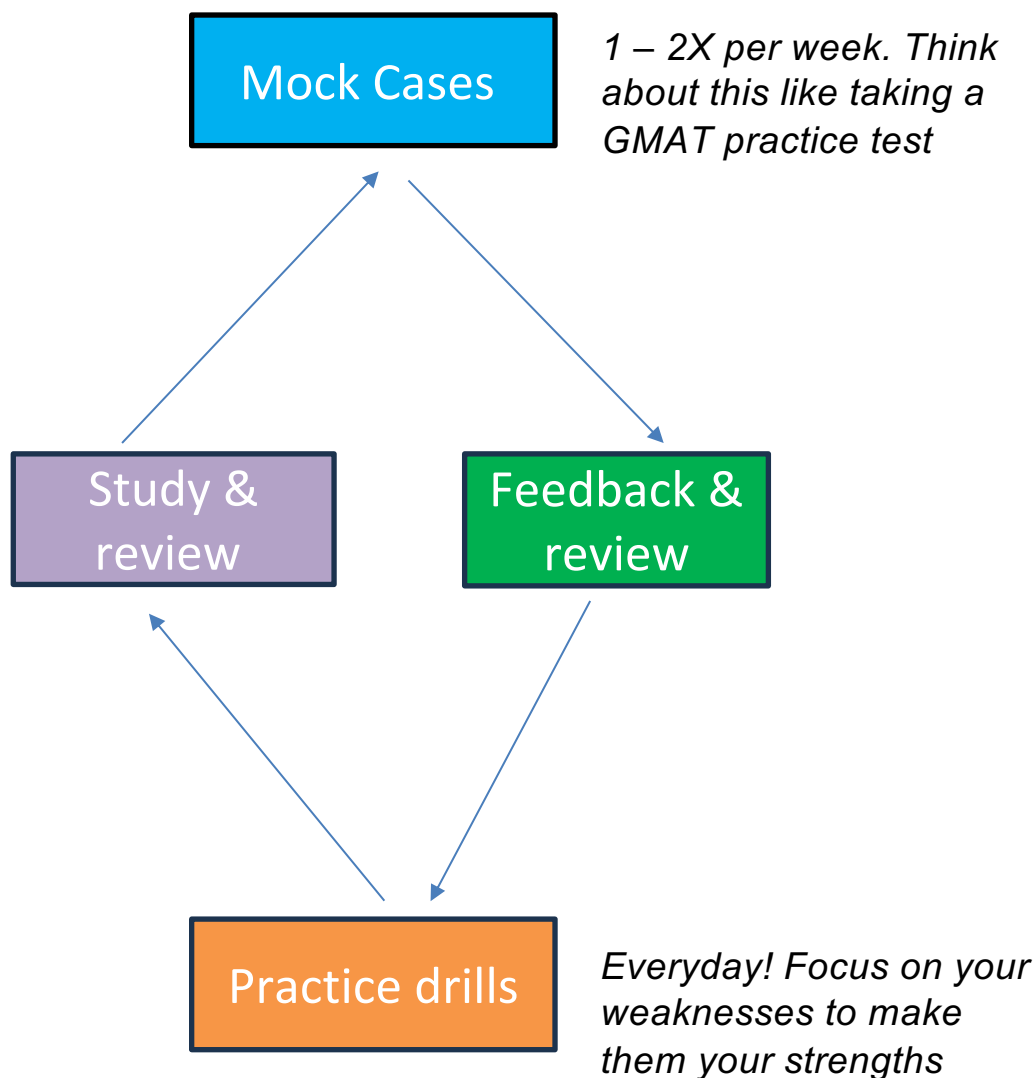
Recommendation

Take a moment to gather your thoughts
Keep it concise!

Follow the 3-step process:

1. **Present recommendation:** Always take a stance
2. **Briefly Recap:** re-emphasize how you got to your recommendation
3. **Address any risks:** we're there assumptions you made in the calculations that influenced your decision?
4. **List next steps:** what is the most logical next thing you'd want to look into?

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When doing mock cases:

- After each mock case, **spend time to revisit it**. Look for ways to improve
- **Take notes about your findings** – Case log
- **Take the feedback seriously** – it's for you to improve
- Do cases with **different people**. Everyone's style is different, and you will have a lot of constructive feedback.
- Once you feel more comfortable, do cases with **people who make you nervous** to fail in front of OR ask your friend to impersonate someone who is less friendly

Perceptions and Reality

In addition to the below, please remember that peer coaches are truly here to help you!!! (I.e. now is the time to mess up and learn from your mistakes with us – we promise we don't leave thinking about your case performance)

I haven't done a case yet - time to bail on recruiting for consulting!

Many successful recruits start late (and many others start early).

If I do a certain number of cases, I should be fine for interviews.

Total # of cases is a poor metric for preparedness (especially across a group).

Case progress is linear.

It's more like a roller coaster, without 95% of the excitement.

I should only case with people I know and am comfortable with.

You have no clue who your interviewers will be and will likely have never met them.

Case feedback is gospel; MBA2s know EVERYTHING.

Be intelligent with and mindful of best practices of handling feedback.

At some point, everything is just going to "click"!

You'll have good *and* bad case performances until the very end.

Pulse Check: Morgan's case log last year

Completed cases at 11/6: 6 (does not include self-guided or FACT group cases)

First Case with Firm Rep (Bain): 11/7

Total Cases: 36

You should be aiming for 2 cases / week; with time in-between to strengthen your weakness areas from last case. **There is no sweet spot for total # of cases.**

If you haven't started yet, it's OK. But next week it will not be - rip that band-aid off ASAP!

Case Giver	Date	Case Name	Case Book	Case Type	Industry	Takeaways
Walter	7/25/22	Phighting Phillies	Wharton 2017	Private Equity	Sports	
Michael	10/3/22	Toto Foundation	Stern '21	Non-Profit	Drones	Be succinct and clear with a recommendation Make brainstorm into mini-frameworks
Michael	10/4/22	Royal Cinema	Stern '21	Turnaround	Entertainment	Take your time with the math when you need to. Being careful and getting the right answer is better than being fast but sloppy.
Anna Haas	10/7/22	Bush's Barber Shop	Kellogg '22	Retail	Retail	After the prompt is read, apply a personal anecdote - how can you relate this problem to something you've read in the news or heard before? Always contextualize the problem and think about it as if we were in the real world.
Eric Chun	10/28/22	SpeedyCo	N/A	Auto	Revenue Growth	1. Framework: More personalization (3C's is a good place to start but start to personalize them). Focus was on revenue growth so try 1st tier and 2nd tier.
Rachel Sze	11/4/22	Chic Cosmotology	Kellogg '20		Profitability	Frameworks: general buckets were fine. Financials should have had more structure. Unprompt investment revenue (# of students * tuition) - give some examples if you need to. Product could be referenced in the questions.
Scott Schag	11/8	Ochestra Case	Stern '21			- Clarifying Questions: Consider the client throughout anything - ask about competition if you need to. Product could be referenced in the questions.
Walter	11/14	SnackCo Aquisition	Wharton			- Need to work on market sizing but overall did really well!
Randy Albert	11/15	Health Coaches	Kellogg			- Clarifying questions: need to always ask about scope
Michaela	11/20	Smiles4Life	Darden 2019			- Prompt: Put prompt into dictation software - keeping track of the details. Respond to the case in a way that gets people excited about you - bring in
Rodney Alberston	11/23	ApplianceCo	Bain 2022		Growth	- Framework: Could have been better to be great, but addressed all key points. General buckets for revenue growth should be: financials, market (growth one).
Victoria Heustenester	11/27	DeBeers	Wharton 2008		Market Sizing	- Overall did really well! Nailed clarifying question. Frameworks was very robust & well delivered. First brainstorm was slightly unstructured. Second
Anna Haas	11/28	Grad-U-Date	Stern 2008		Pricing Strategy	Overall great case! A few areas for improvement

Who should I case with?

- **MBA2s:** You have access to peer coaches from now **until 12/15** - get as many cases in with MBA2's as makes sense for you before the holidays. ALWAYS send then your case log prior to the start of the case practice session.
- **MBA1s:** Find other people in your section, consulting club, strategy class, case competition BUT make sure they know how to case. As this quarter moves forward, we'll release a tool to make it easier to case with other MBA1's
- **Yourself:** I wouldn't count these as actual cases, but it can be a great way to drill your weak areas – open a case book and just start working through prompts, etc! Make sure to add to your case log to avoid someone giving you the same case.
- **Firm Representatives:** You may receive invites to case with a firm - please take these seriously, even if they claim it's "not evaluative". But don't stress out too much, they know you aren't in "interview form" just yet (extra emphasis on desire to learn)

A note on casing with Firm Reps

Firms not evaluating casing as they would in an interview, but are evaluating if they want to work with you

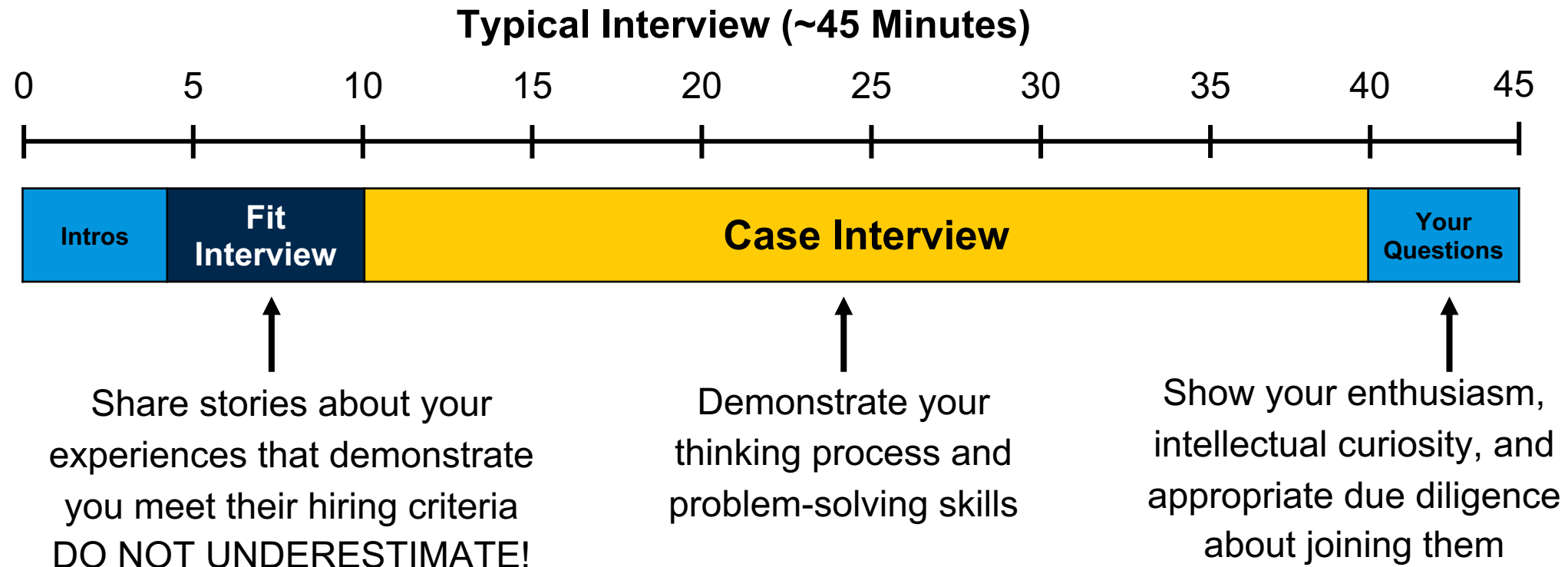
Firm reps want you to succeed! They are taking time out of their day to help you get better - just like any successful case, see it as collaborative, be enthusiastic, appreciative, and kind. If you mess something up, it's OK!

Don't feel pressured to do a mock case until you're ready but keep in mind that firms are more lenient in earlier mock cases.

Please dress accordingly

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Most case interviews follow similar timelines



Firms are always changing!

Make sure you read carefully all materials sent to you by the firm if an interview offer is extended so you're prepared. Second round interviews can be especially atypical. It's a blessing and a curse - there's nothing you can do about it!

Interview formats vary by firm & city

"Super-day": One interview; typically comprised of 2 cases and 1-2 behaviorals **If possible, avoid scheduling 2 super days in one day*

Ex. Bain, BCG, McKinsey 2022

**NOTE: Sometimes case questions will come up in behavioral interviews. Be prepared for anything*

Multi-round: 2-3 interviews across days/weeks; once you "pass" one round, you'll be invited to the next. 2nd round cases usually getting more complicated / complex

Ex. McKinsey 2022, PwC 2022

Presentation Interviews: Some interviews (typically 2 – 3 rounds) will require a presentation to be delivered --> all casing rules still apply!

Ex. LEK 2022

Calculators allowed: Make sure to carefully read all interview instructions. Some firms do allow calculators – it is atypical, but if it does occur still *structure your math & walk interviewer through what you're calculating.*

Ex. Deloitte 2022

Interviewer-led: McKinsey is one example that uses this structure. For the most part, you should treat it like an interviewee-led case (always drive it forward) but leave room for the interviewer to point you in a new direction or ask a different question.

- Forum is November 9 – 10
 - **When you sign up for an event, you MUST go. Please dress appropriately in business attire.**
- CC@R: casebooks (but be strategic), syllabus book, live cases, these decks, our board, MBA2s
- CDO: peer coaches, consulting home page, Randy's suite: tip sheets
- Apps/websites: Management Consulted, Rocket Blocks
- Firm websites: not just for behavioral!
- Business podcasts: some firms, what's current, interesting case studies as parallels
- Read the news! Check pitchbook, stay up to date on current events
- Don't forget: core classes (core concepts), WSJ, YouTube
- Classmates (including those not recruiting for consulting!)

Meet our panelists



Orin McCormick

accenture



Emma Marshall

**McKinsey
& Company**



Eric Brown

Deloitte.



Ryan Rounick
strategy&



Kanika Rana

BCG

Questions to ask

- **Introduce Yourself:** Name, Prior Industry, Firm you interned at, Location, Sanity Tactic during recruiting process
- **At this point, how many cases had you done? Do you wish you had done more or less at that point?**
- **How did you decide what your weaknesses were? Did you call them out from the beginning or did you realize them from peer coach feedback?**
- **How did you ACTUALLY implement feedback you got or things you wanted to work on?**
- **What did your case review process look like?**
- **Apart from 2 allotted Ross Recruit cases, what other resources/tactics did you use? i.e. who did you reach out to case with besides the peer coaches and how did you go about reaching out/scheduling those cases?**
- **Do interview cases really look like the cases with peer coaches? How are they different?**
- **Did you ask peer coaches to be meaner/less engaging to replicate interviews more as you got closer to interviews?**
- **How did you decide how many firms to apply to? How did you decide that was the right number for you?**
- **Anything else you'd like to add?**